

Forestry Placement

Science

May, 2026

Short Title:	Forestry Placement	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Placement and Projects	
Author	TKENT	
Credits	30	Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

The BSc in Forestry values experience-based learning opportunities for students, and the forestry placement module is one important element of this. Placement facilitates students in developing their forestry career by creating links with forestry companies and organisations, and gaining recognition from potential employers of the student's competence and capability. This module is designed to give the student experience of working within a professional forestry company or organisation. The placement is organised by the student with the support and guidance of the forestry placement co-ordinator. The student will gain experience in practical and professional forest management. Students are also encouraged to seek placements abroad, in order to broaden their knowledge of international forestry practice. Forestry students have completed placements in Ireland, the UK, Scandinavia, Central Europe and North America. The objectives of work placement module in the BSc in Forestry are to improve student employability skills, leading to a job-ready forestry graduate; to relate to the workplace the knowledge and competences gained by the student in the academic programme; and to foster closer engagement between the student, the programme and the forestry sector.

Programmes

PLAC-0149 BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)

2 / 4 / E

Indicative Content

- The forestry placement module is a mandatory module in Year 2 Semester 2 of the BSc in Forestry, and consists of a period of at least fifteen weeks duration in a professional forestry organisation in Ireland and/or abroad.
- Students will participate in placement preparation workshops and skills training. Placement preparation activities will include: preparation of CV and company-specific cover letters; interview preparation; health and safety and effective communication.
- Placement opportunities may be identified by the student or placement co-ordinator. Students may apply for more than one placement opportunity but will be expected to accept a placement opportunity that conforms to the forestry placement module requirements. Placements may only proceed, and will only be assessed, with the approval of the work placement co-ordinator.
- Students that have completed placement requirements by May of each year will be assessed in the Semester 2 assessment period. Alternatively, if the placement requirements are completed by August of that year, then students are assessed in the Autumn assessment period.
- Students are assessed on a Pass / Fail basis. Each student will maintain a work journal, signed weekly by their employer and carry out an individual project related to their placement subject to arrangement with the placement co-ordinator. Employers will be supplied with a placement evaluation form to provide feedback to the student and WIT on performance during placement. Students will prepare a short presentation on their placement for the following years students.
- All placement assessment work will be lodged with the placement co-ordinator by specified dates for summer or autumn evaluation.

- The technical work role will vary with each placement, but may involve forest establishment, inventory and mapping, forest protection, harvesting, habitat management, timber measuring and marketing, or other roles. All placements will allow a student to gain transferable skills in personal effectiveness, communications and business organisation.
- Personal effectiveness relates to punctuality, work output and quality, dependability, performing tasks in accordance with directions, using own initiative, adaptability and applying theory to practice
- Communication relates to listening skills, communicating verbally and in writing with co-workers, supervisors, employers and clients.
- Business organisation refers to how the organisation is structured, the roles within the organisation, the clients, customers, suppliers and regulatory authorities with whom the organisation interacts and the policies and procedures used within the organisation.
- Record of placement experience in the form of a Daily Diary and a portfolio of relevant material. Particulars of features of the host organisation, description of enterprise areas, inventory of machinery and technology employed, overview of client base.

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Construct a professional CV and prepare for interview to secure placement.
2. Plan learning objectives for the placement.
3. Operate independently and/or as part of a team towards the set objectives of the forestry enterprise.
4. Apply competently their forestry knowledge and skills in a range of settings.
5. Practise safely, forestry related skills and employ good environmental practices.
6. Examine their personal, professional and technical achievements on the placement.
7. Communicate their activities and assessment of the forestry enterprise in a professional manner.
8. Complete a presentation documenting work practices and experiences using Microsoft PowerPoint.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Workshops on preparing written employment application materials, health and safety and insurance requirements on placement, potential forestry employers and student experiences of forestry placement.
- Communication between student and forestry placement co-ordinator before, during and after placement, including a workplace meeting of the employer, student and placement co-ordinator, to ensure successful outcomes.
- Practical learning experience from a host forestry organisation.
- Practical learning experience keeping a work diary and preparing a report and presentation.
- Working and relating with other co-workers, supervisors and clients.
- Working within a structured work environment, following policies, procedures and best practice.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>Portfolio</i>	Pass/Fail	1,2,6,7
<i>Presentation</i>	Pass/Fail	8
<i>Supervisor's Report</i>	Pass/Fail	3,4,5

Assessment Criteria

- Fail:** Student fails to undertake or complete placement to a satisfactory level and/or fails to submit the assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes.
- Pass:** Minimum period of at least 15 weeks placement completed, satisfactory Supervisor Evaluation Report submitted, and assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes, all to an acceptable standard and submitted within deadlines.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Placement	810	

Essential Material

- "WIT Moodle: Forestry Placement folder: preparation, employment and assessment documentation and resources." <https://moodle.wit.ie/login/index.php>. <https://moodle.wit.ie/login/index.php>

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated